

Question 20 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Design a basic HRD framework for an organisation that wants to improve employee capability while aligning development efforts with organisational goals.

Introduction

A design question needs a clear framework — labelled parts that fit together — not a general essay on the importance of HRD. The organisation's two requirements are: (1) people should become more capable, and (2) that capability must serve organisational goals, not random courses. A basic framework is enough: it should be usable in a medium-sized firm, not a textbook of 40 subsystems.

Think of the framework as a pipeline: goals → required capabilities → diagnosis → development actions → climate support → check results → improve the system.

Detailed points

- 1. Block 1 — HRD philosophy, policy and roles.** Write a short policy signed by top management: people development is a strategic duty; every line manager is a developer of his or her team; the HRD cell designs, facilitates and evaluates; employees also own their learning. Without this block, later tools have no owner and no budget. Policy should mention fairness (equity of access).
- 2. Block 2 — Translate organisational goals into competencies.** Take this year's and next two–three years' goals (quality, expansion, new technology, customer service). For each critical role, list knowledge, skills and attitudes required. This translation is the alignment hinge. If this block is missing, the firm will train whatever a vendor sells.
- 3. Block 3 — Integrated HRD subsystems.** Connect performance appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback and counselling. They must use the same competency language and one employee development file. Appraisal finds gaps; counselling agrees a plan; training and job experiences close gaps; career and potential look at future roles linked to organisational growth.
- 4. Block 4 — HRD climate.** Capability does not stick in a fearful workplace. Build openness, trust, time to practise, and fair access. Supervisors are trained to coach. Climate is not a separate luxury; it is what makes Block 3 work.
- 5. Block 5 — Need diagnosis.** Organisation analysis (goals, where performance hurts), task analysis (KSAs), person analysis (who has the gap). Also check non-training causes (machines, processes). This is TNA sitting inside the HRD framework so that capability building is evidence-based.
- 6. Block 6 — Interventions and individual development plans.** Mix on-the-job learning, formal training, mentoring, e-learning and team OD. Every employee in critical roles has an IDP reviewed against business goals. Succession plans exist for roles that organisational growth will need. This is where capability actually increases.
- 7. Block 7 — Governance.** A small committee of business heads and HRD meets twice a year: are we developing the capabilities our goals require? Line managers have a KRA for team development, not only for output. This prevents HRD from floating away from strategy.
- 8. Block 8 — Evaluation and redesign.** Use reaction, learning, behaviour and result measures for major programmes; climate survey yearly; simple HRD audit of whether mechanisms help or hinder development (T.V. Rao's warning). Feed findings back to Blocks 2 and 5. A framework without this loop will rot into paperwork.

Conclusion. Present eight blocks as your design: policy and roles; goals-to-competencies; integrated subsystems; climate; TNA; interventions/IDPs; governance; evaluation. End by saying employee capability improves and stays aligned with organisational goals only when these blocks work as one framework, not as isolated training events.